

# Nsw Fliptech Equivalents Deep Dive

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## NSW FlipTech equivalents — deep comparative research

Researched: 2 October 2026

Scope: FlipTech Australia, Renew IT, ITC Asset Management, The Reconnect Project, WorkVentures and LinkBytes.

Question: which NSW organisations are genuinely comparable to FlipTech, how did they start, how do they make the model work now, and which pieces are realistic to copy in Dubbo?

This file focuses on business model and operating design, not simply on companies that happen to accept e-waste.

## Executive conclusion

There is no single NSW company that exactly matches the proposed Dubbo E-Waste concept.

Instead, the six organisations sit on a spectrum:

Organisation | Best description | Most relevant lesson for Dubbo

FlipTech Australia | young private e-waste/ITAD company with reuse, secure data handling, recycling and social donation | strongest "started tiny and grew" benchmark

The Reconnect Project | repair/reuse social enterprise + charity + public repair shop | strongest small-scale repair/reuse-first operating model

ITC Asset Management | commercial ITAD, buyback, data destruction, chain of custody and recycling | strongest blueprint for future business/government service

Renew IT | large-scale corporate ITAD + buyback + refurbishment/resale + downstream innovation | clearest mature commercial end-state

WorkVentures | long-running social enterprise combining ITAD, refurbishment, resale and digital inclusion | strongest social/device-bank hybrid

LinkBytes | wholesale refurbished electronics + ITAD/buyback/remarketing | useful resale/wholesale exit model; weaker public historical evidence

The most useful Dubbo synthesis is therefore:

Start like early FlipTech / Reconnect; build process like ITC; scale toward Renew IT only if demand exists; use WorkVentures-style social pathways where appropriate; develop LinkBytes-style wholesale remarketing as an exit for batches.

## 1. FlipTech Australia

### Current identity

FlipTech Australia is a privately held NSW e-waste / IT decommissioning company headquartered in Brookvale.

Public records show:

- current entity: FLIPTECH AUSTRALIA PTY LTD;
- previous entity name: FLIPTECH RECYCLING PTY LTD;
- ABN 54 653 401 024;
- ABN active from 3 September 2021;
- GST registered from 12 January 2023;
- business name FLIPTECH RECYCLING from 6 September 2021;
- NSW Government Buy NSW profile identifies it as a NSW-based SME.

Sources:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/AbnHistory/View?id=54653401024>
- <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/123199>
- <https://au.linkedin.com/company/fliptech-australia>

## Founder and origin story

FlipTech's founder is Austin Turpin.

Independent reporting says Austin started the idea at about 15 years old after seeing a large amount of discarded electronics at a local tip.

The business reportedly began from the family garage.

Later reporting described the then-20-year-old founder as having grown FlipTech into an operation with employees and nationwide clients.

Sources:

- <https://www.dailytelegraph.com.au/newslocal/manly-daily/fliptech-warriewood-austin-turpin-blossoms-from-teen-ewaste-entrepreneur-to-computer-recycling-boss/news-story/d4647eb51bfe76aa68bef295c85e29e7>
- <https://warriewoodnews.com.au/warriewood-teen-turns-e-waste-into-gold/>
- <https://open.spotify.com/show/4u5ci9897ICp2uuNmi8AOA> — Killoway Report, Ep.7, 18 Sep 2020
- <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/austin-turpin-applying-bbit-to-build-a-business/id1579827759?i=1000709099232>

## Important chronology nuance

LinkedIn says FlipTech was founded in 2019, while the current company ABN begins in September 2021.

That is consistent with a startup period before the present company structure, but the public evidence does not establish the exact legal arrangement used during 2019–2021.

## What FlipTech does now

FlipTech publicly positions itself as:

- secure e-waste / IT decommissioning;
- collection;

- sorting;
- secure data erasure;
- refurbishment / repurposing;
- material recycling;
- social donation.

Its Buy NSW profile specifically describes services for:

- corporate;
- residential;
- social-enterprise clients.

Source:

- <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/123199>

## Collection model

FlipTech offers e-waste bins to buildings/businesses.

Published process:

1. FlipTech delivers a bin.
2. Customer fills it.
3. FlipTech collects/replaces it.
4. Material is sorted at FlipTech's facility.
5. Data-bearing assets are securely erased.
6. Material is routed onward.

Source:

- <https://www.fliptech.com.au/bins>

Austin has also publicly advertised free recycling and data erasure for redundant electronics Sydney-wide.

Source:

- [https://www.linkedin.com/posts/austin-turpin-1608a91a1\\_got-e-waste-fliptech-provides-free-recycling-activity-7046635900344152064-8S2F](https://www.linkedin.com/posts/austin-turpin-1608a91a1_got-e-waste-fliptech-provides-free-recycling-activity-7046635900344152064-8S2F)

Do not assume that means every category / every postcode / every volume is always free in 2026; quote conditions can change.

## Data security

FlipTech publishes a detailed secure-custody approach including:

- unmarked locked collection vehicles;
- monitored transport;
- secure facility;
- 24/7 surveillance;

- restricted authorised access;
- data-erasure software;
- stated alignment to NIST 800-88 and DoD standards;
- Certificate of Destruction.

Source:

- <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/8e4e2ca7-22e2-4d68-bf22-d0420c297db4>

## **Evidence caution**

FlipTech uses wording such as "certified data erasure" and "Global Standards Framework".

This research did not independently verify a specific current ISO certification scope or AS/NZS 5377 certification from an external accreditation register.

Do not turn marketing wording into a certification claim without the certificate/scope.

## **Reuse/refurbishment**

FlipTech explicitly says it focuses on:

- responsible disposal;
- recycling;
- refurbishing IT equipment;
- ensuring devices are either repurposed or recycled.

Source:

- <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/53b6be97-e467-4c86-9dc7-7bc1d9dff119>

Independent reporting says usable equipment/components are refurbished/resold while true end-of-life equipment is recycled.

Source:

- Daily Telegraph reporting above.

## **Social reuse**

FlipTech has a documented partnership with Royal Far West.

Its own published explanation says much of the suitable IT collected through that relationship can be donated back into communities, particularly supporting rural/remote Australian children.

Source:

- <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/3b6db187-5654-4e59-9515-e3202851afce>

## **Why this matters to Dubbo**

Royal Far West is specifically concerned with rural and remote children.

That makes FlipTech's social-reuse model unusually relevant to a regional NSW project.

## Revenue model — best public reconstruction

Likely revenue streams include:

- collection / IT decommissioning services;
- secure data-erasure services;
- resale of reusable/refurbished devices/components;
- commodity/recycling recovery;
- ongoing bin/service arrangements.

The exact revenue split is not public.

## Why FlipTech is relevant

FlipTech is the strongest example in this comparison of:

young founder → garage → collect unwanted electronics → learn the stream → professionalise data/security → business/government clients → warehouse/facility → reuse + recycling + social donation

That is much closer to the desired Dubbo growth path than starting as a mature industrial recycler.

## What Dubbo could copy now

- start small;
- prioritise usable business IT;
- offer convenient pickup;
- treat data handling as core value;
- keep reuse ahead of recycling;
- build a social redistribution path;
- document what happens to assets.

## What Dubbo should not copy yet

- unattended building bins;
- broad indiscriminate intake;
- national collection promises;
- security/certification language not actually held;
- warehouse overhead before supply is proven.

## 2. Renew IT

### Current identity

Renew IT is a large Australian-owned IT asset lifecycle / ITAD business headquartered at:

91 Mars Road, Lane Cove West NSW 2066.

Current group entity shown on its site:

- Renew IT Group Pty Ltd
- ABN 21 659 631 946

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/contact-us/>
- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?id=21659631946>

## Founder and origin story

Founder and CEO: James Lancaster.

Renew IT says it was established in 2008.

A 2024 founder profile says Lancaster started the business in his garage in 2007.

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/>
- <https://renew-it.com/about-us/>
- <https://renew-it.com/2024/04/08/national-finalist-in-ey-entrepreneur-of-the-year-2024-australia/>

That makes Renew IT another very strong example of:

|                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| garage → specialised problem → scale behind enterprise demand. |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|

## Current scale

Renew IT's own 2024 founder profile says:

- 200+ employees;
- facilities across Australia and New Zealand;
- approximately 40,000 computers processed every month;
- around 35% annual revenue growth at the time of the profile.

Its current site says the business operates six processing facilities across Australia and New Zealand, and has since expanded internationally.

Sources:

- <https://renew-it.com/2024/04/08/national-finalist-in-ey-entrepreneur-of-the-year-2024-australia/>
- <https://renew-it.com/>
- <https://renew-it.com/international/>

## 2021 acquisition

Renew IT acquired Verser Technology Lifecycle Services in 2021.

Renew IT says the acquisition expanded national capability and strengthened government-facing lifecycle services.

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/renews/>

## Core commercial model

Renew IT's current model is highly relevant to Dubbo:

1. businesses refresh fleets;
2. Renew IT offers buyback for redundant IT;
3. data is sanitised;
4. viable hardware is refurbished for resale;
5. older/non-saleable hardware goes to downstream material recovery.

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/>

That is effectively the mature version of the business model being designed in this repo.

## Data sanitisation

Renew IT says it sanitises data to NIST 800-88.

The public site uses this as part of the buyback/refurbishment service.

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/>

For Dubbo, the key lesson is commercial:

|                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| businesses may accept refurbishment/resale when the vendor can prove the old data is gone. |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Refurbishment / resale

Renew IT explicitly says it:

- buys redundant IT;
- sanitises it;
- refurbishes hardware for resale;
- returns value to the client.

This makes resale a central ITAD outcome, not a secondary hobby.

## Downstream: UNSW MICROfactorie

Renew IT partnered with the UNSW SMaRT Centre.

At its Lane Cove warehouse, a commercially operated plastics-filament MICROfactorie turns discarded hard plastics from e-waste into 3D-printer feedstock.

Source:

- <https://renew-it.com/renews/>
- <https://www.smart.unsw.edu.au/news-events/news/commercial-success-story-smarts-plastics-microfactorie-tech>

## **Why this matters**

It demonstrates a mature separation of roles:

- high-value whole-device reuse occurs first;
- specialist material innovation handles the difficult residual fraction.

Dubbo does not need to replicate this processing technology.

Dubbo needs a trustworthy partner for this stage.

## **Customer base**

Renew IT says it works with:

- SMEs;
- corporations;
- schools;
- universities;
- manufacturers;
- government.

## **Revenue model**

Public evidence supports revenue/value streams including:

- lifecycle services;
- ITAD;
- fleet deployment/recovery;
- buyback;
- asset remarketing/resale;
- data sanitisation;
- logistics;
- downstream recovery services;
- professional technology services.

Exact revenue by stream is not public.

## **What Dubbo could copy now**

- focus on business fleet refreshes;
- pay attention to residual asset value;
- data sanitisation before resale;
- resale whole devices where viable;
- transparent residual recycling route.

## **What belongs much later**

- multi-state facilities;
- 200+ staff;
- dedicated material-processing technology;
- national enterprise tenders;
- acquisition-led growth.

## **3. ITC Asset Management**

### **Current identity**

ITC Asset Management is a NSW commercial ITAD provider based at:

Unit 25, 16 Loyalty Road, North Rocks NSW 2151.

Legal entity:

- ITC Solutions Australia Pty Ltd
- ABN 56 642 454 395
- ABN active from 8 July 2020
- business name ITC Asset Management from 8 January 2021

Source:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/56642454395>
- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/>

### **Operating history**

ITC's current website says it has been operating since 2018.

Its current company structure/ABN dates from 2020.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/locations/>
- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/about-us/>

The exact pre-2020 legal structure/founder chronology was not established in this pass.

## Market focus

This is a business-focused operation, not a household drop-off model.

ITC explicitly says it is built for commercial IT assets, including:

- businesses;
- government;
- health;
- universities;
- councils;
- education;
- enterprise.

Source:

- <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/89282>
- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/it-asset-disposal-sydney/>

## Why ITC is probably the best process blueprint for future Dubbo B2B work

ITC describes a tightly controlled process:

1. assets logged at collection;
2. secure chain of custody;
3. ITC employees transport data-bearing equipment;
4. devices sanitised or physically destroyed;
5. assets triaged for reuse/remarketing;
6. residuals recycled;
7. client gets certificates + disposition reporting.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/it-asset-disposal-sydney/>
- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/locations/>

This is almost exactly the workflow the Dubbo repo has independently evolved toward.

## Certifications

Buy NSW and ITC's site currently list:

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 — information security;
- ISO 14001:2015 — environmental management;
- ISO 9001:2015 — quality;
- ISO 45001:2018 — WHS.

Source:

- <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/89282>
- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/about-us/>

Its recycling workflow is described as in line with AS/NZS 5377.

## **Data destruction**

ITC offers:

- software sanitisation;
- physical shredding;
- degaussing where appropriate;
- on-site/witnessed destruction;
- serialised Certificates of Destruction;
- device-level records.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/data-destruction-services-sydney/>

## **Logistics / chain of custody**

One particularly useful differentiator is that ITC says:

- data-bearing collection is handled by its own employees;
- secure transport is documented;
- asset records begin on-site;
- data destruction occurs before recycling;
- regional/interstate collections use the same process controls.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/locations/>

## **Dubbo implication**

A regional operation can compete on trust/process, not industrial scale.

Even if downstream processing happens elsewhere, the local operator can own:

- intake;
- custody;
- serial records;
- sanitisation;
- triage;
- final disposition evidence.

## **Buyback / value recovery**

ITC buys:

- desktops;
- laptops;
- servers;
- network hardware;
- storage arrays;
- monitors;
- mobile devices.

Working assets can be refurbished/remarketed, while the rest is recycled.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/it-asset-buyback-sydney/>

ITC calls its rebate/value-recovery approach a Buy-Residual Flywheel in its Buy NSW profile.

## **Collection pricing**

ITC says qualifying Sydney commercial volumes can receive free collection.

Smaller jobs can attract a minimum service charge.

Source:

- <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/data-destruction-services-sydney/>

This is important because "free collection" can be funded by:

- residual device value;
- job size;
- paid services;
- commercial scale.

It is not evidence that every small batch is economic to collect for free.

## **What Dubbo could copy first**

- business-only scheduled intake;
- manifest / serial recording;
- secure transport;
- strict data-state control;
- buyback/residual value assessment;
- certificates;
- full asset disposition reports;
- own-client-facing process even if downstream is outsourced.

## **What comes later**

- multiple ISO certifications;
- on-site shredding;
- national logistics;
- enterprise/government procurement;
- large secure facility.

## **4. The Reconnect Project**

### **Current identity**

The Reconnect Project is a NSW charity/social enterprise based in Penshurst.

Legal entity:

- The Reconnect Project Limited
- ABN 50 634 550 388
- active from 1 July 2019
- registered charity from July 2019
- GST registered from December 2024.

Source:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/50634550388>
- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/>

Founder and CEO: Annette Brodie.

### **Origin story**

This is probably the best small-model comparison in NSW.

Annette says the concept began in 2018 when she researched what happened to pre-owned smartphones.

She discovered that some devices entering industrial shredding still had useful life if repaired.

The Reconnect Project:

- was founded in 2019;
- publicly launched in February 2020;
- initially used a shared workspace;
- pivoted to working from home almost immediately because of COVID;
- opened the Penshurst repair shop in early 2021.

Source:

- [https://www.linkedin.com/posts/annette-brodie\\_i-have-an-aversion-to-the-word-scale-the-activity-7444257939227340800-gAs1](https://www.linkedin.com/posts/annette-brodie_i-have-an-aversion-to-the-word-scale-the-activity-7444257939227340800-gAs1)
- <https://www.smallbusiness.nsw.gov.au/news-podcasts/news/annette-brodie-how-a-tech-repair-shop-is-making-a-difference-in-sydney>

## Startup funding

In its Productivity Commission submission, The Reconnect Project says it began with only \$5,000 in crowdfunding.

Source:

- <https://assets.pc.gov.au/387583/sub134-circular-economy.pdf>

That is very important for Dubbo:

a working repair/reuse model can start with thousands, not hundreds of thousands, if intake is constrained and industrial processing is outsourced.

## The original problem Annette identified

The key insight was not "e-waste needs recycling."

It was:

some older devices sent toward shredding no longer had much commercial value but still had 2-3 years of useful life if repaired.

That is almost exactly the core Dubbo hypothesis.

## What it accepts

Current donation policy:

- mobile phones: all makes/models/ages/conditions;
- tablets: all makes/models/ages/conditions;
- laptops: currently less than 8 years old.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/donate/>

This shows an important maturity lesson:

acceptance criteria evolve.

The organisation historically described taking extremely broad device donations, but its current laptop rule is more selective.

## Triage / repair / parts

Current published process:

1. donated device received;
2. triage assesses function;
3. required parts identified;
4. technicians repair;
5. secure erase;
6. reuse/distribution/resale;
7. unrepairable devices become donor parts;
8. remaining broken parts/devices go to Australian recyclers.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/donate/>

The Product Stewardship Centre of Excellence has described its hierarchy as:

1. repair;
2. parts harvesting;
3. materials recycling last.

Source:

- [https://www.linkedin.com/posts/the-reconnect-project\\_annette-brodie-centre-of-excellence-activity-7311233696219504640-x6nW](https://www.linkedin.com/posts/the-reconnect-project_annette-brodie-centre-of-excellence-activity-7311233696219504640-x6nW)

That is virtually the same hierarchy adopted in this repo.

## **Data erasure**

The Reconnect Project uses Blancco.

It says a Certificate of Erasure can be provided and asks for a \$5 contribution per device to cover that cost.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/donate/>

## **Repair economics / social-enterprise revenue**

The Reconnect Project's public model is ingenious because paid repair work helps fund the social mission.

Its training page describes:

Profits = Progress — repair fees support the organisation's work.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/training/>

The NSW Small Business Commissioner reported in 2025 that the Penshurst shop had:

- ten staff;
- five technicians;

- a workshop supervisor;
- support/shopfront staff.

Source:

- <https://www.smallbusiness.nsw.gov.au/news-podcasts/news/annette-brodie-how-a-tech-repair-shop-is-making-a-difference-in-sydney>

## **Refurbished resale**

The organisation told the Productivity Commission that it sells some refurbished equipment through:

- eBay;
- Reebelo;
- direct customer sales.

Source:

- <https://assets.pc.gov.au/387583/sub134-circular-economy.pdf>

That makes it not merely a donation charity; it also participates in the second-hand/refurb market.

## **Distribution**

Refurbished devices are distributed via support agencies including:

- women's shelters;
- refugee services;
- youth outreach/support services.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/about-us/>

## **Real restoration cost**

The donation page states an average cost of about \$200 to restore each device.

Source:

- <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/donate/>

This is useful because it shows why "free donated laptops" are not economically free after:

- labour;
- parts;
- storage;
- data wiping;
- admin;
- support.

## Grants and sustainability

Early reporting says local-council funding helped establish the project.

A City of Sydney annual report records a \$33,000 Staying Connected grant in 2019/20.

Source:

- <https://www.cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au/-/media/corporate/files/publications/research-and-reports/annual-reports/statutory-returns-annual-report-2019-20.pdf>

However, Annette explicitly said the organisation could not rely on grants forever and opened the repair shop to create an earned-income stream.

Source:

- <https://www.frankie.com.au/article/the-reconnect-project-gives-old-technology-a-second-life-563637>

## Skills / employment model

The organisation trains and employs neurodivergent young adults in repair.

Its Productivity Commission submission says it developed an Australian Mobile Device Repair training program and was piloting formal training.

## Barriers identified by Reconnect

Its Productivity Commission submission is extremely relevant to Dubbo.

It identifies barriers including:

- OEM parts pairing;
- Apple/Google account locks;
- donated devices becoming nonviable because locks cannot be removed;
- limited funding for upstream repair/reuse compared with downstream recycling.

Source:

- <https://assets.pc.gov.au/387583/sub134-circular-economy.pdf>

## What Dubbo could copy immediately

- selective device classes;
- triage before dismantling;
- donor-parts bins;
- no assumption that low-value = no useful life;
- repair services as an earned-income stream;
- use external recyclers for the residue;
- small workspace before industrial premises;
- Blancco/documented erasure later if clients justify cost.

## **What should not be copied automatically**

- broad public intake;
- charity structure;
- dependence on grants;
- expensive repairs where market value does not justify them;
- assuming every donated device has a social-use destination.

## **5. WorkVentures**

### **Current identity**

WorkVentures is a long-running NSW public company/charity/social enterprise.

Current entity:

- WorkVentures Ltd
- ABN 74 002 721 217
- main business location Alexandria NSW.

Source:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/74002721217>

### **Origin**

WorkVentures' organisational history begins in 1979 as Peninsula Community Services.

Founder: Steve Lawrence AO.

The organisation says it later moved into:

- computer training;
- employment services;
- electronic repair;
- technology reuse;
- digital inclusion.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/about-us/>
- <https://workventures.com.au/our-history/>

Historical WorkVentures material says an electronic repair business existed by the early 1990s.

This is therefore not a startup analogue in the same way FlipTech/Reconnect are; it is a mature institutional benchmark.

## Current business structure

WorkVentures combines:

- CircularIT / ITAD;
- secure data destruction;
- device refurbishment;
- resale;
- logistics;
- digital-inclusion programs;
- employment/training;
- National Device Bank work.

## CircularIT flow

Current published CircularIT model:

- collect retired IT;
- securely wipe;
- repurpose/refurbish;
- resell or distribute;
- recycle residuals;
- provide impact/sustainability reporting.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/circularit/>

## Refurbishment process

WorkVentures publicly describes a lifecycle very similar to Dubbo's planned process:

1. customer engagement;
2. secure collection;
3. secure data destruction;
4. assurance/compliance;
5. technical assessment/triage;
6. e-waste recycling for failures;
7. reuse/refurbishment;
8. sustainability reporting.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/refurbishment/>

It also highlights MDM locks as a major reason otherwise useful donated laptops can become unusable.

That reinforces the need to make organisation-lock removal part of the donor handoff process.

## **What WorkVentures refurbishes**

Examples include:

- laptops;
- PCs;
- modems;
- NTUs;
- historically CRT monitors;
- other technical equipment.

It says it has refurbished 50,000+ modems/NTUs in one service area.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/refurbishment/>

## **Refurbished resale**

WorkVentures operates a public online refurbished-device shop.

Current examples include business-class systems such as:

- Dell Latitude 5300;
- HP EliteBook 830 G7;
- Lenovo ThinkPad X13;
- Surface devices.

Current store prices observed in this research are typically several hundred dollars depending on configuration.

Source:

- <https://shop.workventures.com.au/>
- <https://shop.workventures.com.au/product-category/refurbished-laptop/>

## **Warranty/support**

WorkVentures commonly provides:

- 6-month warranty;
- technical support;
- shipping;
- setup/support services.

Some partnership campaigns show 12-month warranty terms.

Sources:

- <https://workventures.com.au/shop-home/>

- <https://workventures.com.au/manyivers/>

## **Dubbo implication**

The value proposition isn't merely "cheap laptop."

It is:

|                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------|
| refurbished + tested + warranty + support + social impact. |
|------------------------------------------------------------|

That supports charging more than a random Facebook Marketplace seller if the service level is materially better.

## **Certifications / assurance**

WorkVentures' own quality page lists:

- ACNC registered charity;
- Social Traders certification;
- ISO 9001.

Its logistics page also refers to secure media sanitisation aligned to NIST 800-88 and partner-network certifications including R2, ISO 14001 and AS 5377.

Sources:

- <https://workventures.com.au/quality-certification/>
- <https://workventures.com.au/logistics-solutions/>

## **Evidence nuance**

Some environmental/recycling certifications are described as held within its partner network, not necessarily all directly by WorkVentures.

Do not attribute every partner certification directly to WorkVentures.

## **National / NSW Device Bank**

WorkVentures is a co-founder of the National Device Bank.

Its NSW Device Bank page says the current NSW pilot:

- is NSW-only;
- currently repurposes NSW Government devices;
- distributes through registered charities/not-for-profits;
- is not a direct public application scheme.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/national-device-bank/>
- <https://workventures.com.au/nswdb-eoi/>

## Financial scale

WorkVentures' 2024 financial report says:

- gross revenue: \$9,335,744;
- reported loss: \$198,335;
- one-off restructuring costs: \$249,869;
- excluding those restructuring costs, management says operating surplus would have been \$51,534.

Its activities included:

- digital inclusion through sale of refurbished technology;
- decommissioning;
- sanitisation;
- asset management;
- reuse/recycling;
- electronic repairs/testing/configuration;
- cybersecurity.

Source:

- <https://workventures.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/WV-2024-Financial-Report-final.pdf>

## Why this matters

Even at roughly \$9.3m gross revenue, this is not a magically high-margin business.

That reinforces the need to track:

- labour;
- logistics;
- support;
- storage;
- grants/contracts;
- device value;
- disposal cost.

## What Dubbo could copy

- social + commercial hybrid;
- business donation pathway;
- impact reporting;
- tested/warranted refurbished devices;
- MDM-lock checklist;
- digital-inclusion destination partnerships;
- resale/support bundles.

## What is not Phase 0

- registered charity/social-enterprise structure;
- large formal workforce;
- training programs;
- device-bank infrastructure;
- national clients.

## 6. LinkBytes

### Current identity

LinkBytes currently markets itself as a Sydney-based:

- ITAD provider;
- wholesale refurbished-hardware seller;
- fleet buyback/remarketing business.

Current legal entity:

- LINK BYTES PTY LTD
- ABN 79 673 773 165
- active/GST registered from 20 December 2023
- main business location NSW 2170.

Source:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?id=79673773165>

### Public-history inconsistency

This is important.

LinkBytes' own current website says:

- "Sydney, Australia · Since 2014"
- "12+ years of experience"

But:

- ABR says the current company entity started in December 2023;
- LinkedIn says the company was founded in 2022.

Sources:

- <https://www.linkbytes.com.au/>
- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?id=79673773165>
- <https://au.linkedin.com/company/link-bytes>

## **Correct treatment**

Do not state that the current Australian company was legally operating since 2014.

The site may be referring to founder/team/overseas/industry experience, an earlier business, or another commercial history.

The exact continuity was not proven in this research.

Of all six organisations in this file, LinkBytes has the least clear public origin chronology.

## **Current model**

Its current site says it offers two major streams:

### **ITAD**

- audits;
- asset management;
- relocation;
- lifecycle/deployment work;
- buyback of retired IT;
- data destruction;
- chain of custody;
- reporting/certificates.

## **Refurbished resale / wholesale**

Categories include:

- Apple devices;
- laptops;
- desktops/workstations;
- mini PCs;
- monitors;
- smartphones;
- tablets;
- enterprise networking.

Source:

- <https://www.linkbytes.com.au/>

## **Current scale claims**

LinkBytes' own site claims:

- 500+ businesses served;
- 50,000+ devices refurbished;

- warranty on refurbished equipment;
- global/wholesale distribution;
- clients/sources including government, universities, schools and large organisations.

These are company claims and were not independently audited in this research.

## Wholesale relevance

Public employee posts describe bulk trading of hundreds of devices and a business interest in buying used/refurbished equipment in large quantities.

Source:

- <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/muhammad-faizan-97b4b1169>

This makes LinkBytes interesting as a possible bulk remarketing model.

A regional operator does not necessarily need to retail every usable device one-by-one.

Possible future exit:

Dubbo collects/test/sanitises batches → sells lower-margin consistent batches wholesale.

That can reduce:

- listing labour;
- customer support;
- storage time;
- individual shipping effort.

## Warranty / support

The current LinkBytes site says:

- refurbished equipment includes written warranty;
- technical support is available;
- devices are tested by technicians.

## What Dubbo could copy

- whole-fleet buyback;
- wholesale remarketing;
- batch sales;
- multi-category resale;
- written warranty;
- capture value before recycling.

## Caution

Until its historical/certification claims are independently verified, use LinkBytes primarily as a current market-model benchmark, not as the strongest compliance/certification benchmark.

## 7. Side-by-side operating comparison

| Feature                                    | FlipTech                        | Renew IT                        | ITC                    | Reconnect                      | WorkVentures                        | LinkBytes               |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| NSW based                                  | Yes                             | HQ NSW                          | Yes                    | Yes                            | Yes                                 | Yes                     |
| Tiny/home-style origin publicly documented | Yes                             | Yes                             | Partly/unknown         | Yes                            | No – community org                  | origin   Unclear        |
| Business IT collections                    | Yes                             | Yes                             | Core                   | Yes/bulk donations             | Core                                | Core                    |
| Household/public donations                 | Some/public-facing              | Not main model                  | No – commercial focus  | Core                           | donation/program dependent          | Not main model          |
| Secure data erasure                        | Yes                             | Yes                             | Core                   | Yes                            | Yes                                 | Yes                     |
| Refurbishment                              | Yes                             | Core                            | Yes                    | Core                           | Core                                | Core                    |
| Whole-device resale                        | Yes                             | Core                            | Yes                    | Some                           | Core                                | Core                    |
| Buyback / value rebate                     | Likely/value recovery           | Core                            | Core                   | No donation-led model          | Yes/value recovery possible         | Core                    |
| Social redistribution                      | Yes                             | Not core                        | Not core               | Core                           | Core                                | Not evident as core     |
| Repair shop                                | Not public core                 | Enterprise lifecycle            | Not public retail      | Core                           | Technical services                  | Not public retail       |
| Donor-part harvesting                      | Likely but not deeply published | Explicit                        | refurbishment          | not clearly documented         | industrial process                  | likely triage           |
| Material recycling                         | Yes                             | Yes + advanced downstream       | Yes                    | outsourced                     | partner network                     | yes/ITAD                |
| Publicly detailed certifications           | Limited evidence                | substantial enterprise evidence | Strongest explicit set | charity/social rather than ISO | mixed direct/partner certifications | limited public evidence |
| Best Dubbo lesson                          | start tiny + B2B                | eventual scale                  | process/control        | reuse-first micro model        | social ecosystem                    | wholesale exit          |

## 8. Startup path comparison

### FlipTech

tip observation → teenage founder → family garage → local NSW e-waste → formal company → business/government collections → secure data → warehouse/facility → social partnerships

### Renew IT

garage in 2007 → established specialist in 2008 → corporate fleet lifecycle → acquisition → national footprint → 200+ staff → ~40,000 computers/month → advanced materials partnership

### ITC

operating from ~2018 → current company from 2020 → North Rocks secure facility → commercial ITAD → four ISO certifications → government/health/education/enterprise clients

### Reconnect

research problem in 2018 → \$5k crowdfunding → charity founded 2019 → shared workspace → home COVID pivot → repair/refurb/social distribution → Penshurst shop 2021 → paid repairs + training + resale

### WorkVentures

community organisation 1979 → training/employment → electronic repair/computer programs → long-running refurbishment/social enterprise → ITAD/CircularIT + online refurb store + Device Bank

## **LinkBytes**

public origin chronology unresolved → current Australian company from Dec 2023 → wholesale used/refurb market + ITAD/buyback + international resale

## **9. Which one is closest to the proposed Dubbo E-Waste model?**

### **Closest origin story: FlipTech**

Why:

- founder started very young;
- garage origin;
- saw discarded computers as opportunity;
- moved from small/local to professional e-waste/ITAD;
- reuse + recycling + social redistribution.

This is the strongest proof that an NSW operator can evolve from a tiny start into a credible business.

### **Closest Phase 0 operating model: The Reconnect Project**

Why:

- started with very little capital;
- shared/home-scale beginnings;
- repair before recycling;
- donor parts;
- selective/current device rules;
- external downstream recycling;
- paid repair creates cash flow;
- resale and social redistribution are both valid outputs.

### **Closest future B2B process: ITC Asset Management**

Why:

- secure manifests;
- own chain of custody;
- device-level evidence;
- sanitisation;
- certificates;

- buyback;
- remarketing;
- recycling;
- disposition reports.

If Dubbo eventually approaches schools, councils, health providers or larger businesses, ITC is the process to study most closely.

## **Closest mature commercial end-state: Renew IT**

Why:

- fleet refresh;
- buyback;
- secure data;
- refurbishment/resale;
- material recovery;
- sustainability reporting;
- national scale.

Renew IT shows what the business can become without requiring Dubbo to process raw materials itself.

## **Closest social-impact end-state: WorkVentures**

Why:

- business ITAD feeds refurbishment;
- refurbished devices are sold/distributed affordably;
- digital inclusion and commercial services reinforce one another;
- impact reporting makes device donation attractive to corporates/government.

## **Best wholesale-market benchmark: LinkBytes**

Why:

- bulk used/refurb hardware;
- business fleet purchases;
- multi-category inventory;
- global resale;
- wholesale rather than one-by-one consumer selling.

# **10. Best hybrid for Dubbo**

The best model is not to clone one company.

It is to combine six useful pieces.

## **Phase 0 — use Reconnect + early FlipTech**

- own small workspace;
- scheduled/pre-approved intake;
- mostly laptops/desktops/phones/tablets;
- repair/reuse before parts;
- parts before recycling;
- learn the real economics;
- use existing downstream recyclers;
- keep capital low;
- no big warehouse.

## **Phase 1 — add ITC discipline**

- intake manifest;
- asset/serial capture;
- chain of custody;
- business transfer authority;
- documented sanitisation;
- disposition report;
- clear buyback or collection quote.

## **Phase 2 — add Renew IT economics**

- target fleet refreshes;
- value the batch before pickup;
- return some residual value where commercially sensible;
- build repeat business clients;
- separate resale-grade from recycling-grade quickly.

## **Phase 3 — add WorkVentures social routes**

- charity/device-bank partners;
- impact reporting;
- selected donated devices;
- affordable refurbished sales;
- community redistribution.

## **Phase 4 — add LinkBytes-style wholesale exits**

- sell consistent laptop batches;
- wholesale slow-moving but usable assets;
- move stock faster;

- reduce individual eBay labour.

## **11. Practical service design this research suggests**

A future Dubbo business service could look like:

### **1. Client sends an asset list**

Preferably:

- make/model;
- rough age;
- quantity;
- device type;
- data-bearing status;
- known locks;
- location.

### **2. Dubbo pre-values the batch**

Classify:

- likely resale;
- possible refurb;
- donor/parts;
- likely recycling liability.

### **3. Quote the whole job**

Possible structure:

service fee + collection fee + data service – residual buyback value

That is more sustainable than promising "everything free".

### **4. At collection**

Record:

- asset ID;
- serial;
- client;
- transfer authority;
- condition;
- custody time.

## **5. Secure data first**

No resale/parts route until sanitisation is completed and recorded.

## **6. Fast triage**

Within a defined time budget:

- A — resale whole;
- B — cheap repair;
- C — donor parts;
- D — social reuse if appropriate;
- E — downstream recycling.

## **7. Sell through multiple exits**

- direct local;
- eBay;
- wholesale batches;
- social partner;
- parts;
- downstream recycler.

## **8. Give client a report**

At minimum:

- items collected;
- data outcome;
- reuse/refurb count;
- donated/social count;
- recycled count;
- buyback/rebate;
- exceptions.

This is the most transferable common feature across the serious ITAD operators.

# **12. What all six companies collectively prove**

## **1. The valuable business is upstream of shredding**

Every useful comparison attempts to extract value before raw-material recycling:

- resale;
- refurbishment;

- repair;
- redeployment;
- social donation;
- component recovery.

That strongly validates the core Dubbo thesis.

## **2. Data is a commercial service**

Data sanitisation is not just a compliance nuisance.

For business clients it is one of the reasons to choose a specialist operator.

## **3. Fleet refreshes are better than random waste**

Businesses/government/education generate:

- consistent models;
- predictable age;
- documented ownership;
- batch volume;
- residual value.

This is why Renew IT, ITC, WorkVentures and LinkBytes are heavily fleet-oriented.

## **4. Free collection works only when something funds it**

Possible funding mechanisms include:

- residual device value;
- paid data service;
- commercial service fee;
- scale/route density;
- grant/social funding;
- commodity value.

There is no evidence that "collect everything for free" is intrinsically sustainable.

## **5. Low-value equipment is the dangerous part of the model**

Renew IT's origin stories about hard-to-process residuals and Reconnect's selective/current laptop rule both reinforce the same point:

supply is not the problem; good supply is the problem.

## **6. Account/MDM locks destroy reuse value**

Reconnect and WorkVentures both identify device locks as a major barrier.

A Dubbo donor/client checklist should require organisations to remove:

- Apple Activation Lock / Find My;
- Google/FRP;
- Windows Autopilot;
- MDM;
- BIOS/firmware passwords where possible.

## **7. Repair can be its own revenue stream**

Reconnect demonstrates that repair revenue can subsidise the broader reuse mission.

This matters because resale alone can be lumpy.

## **8. Wholesale is an important exit**

LinkBytes shows that once enough consistent assets are available, one-by-one local resale is not the only market.

## **9. Certification comes after process maturity**

FlipTech and Renew IT both began tiny.

ITC's current four-ISO setup is a mature business-control state, not evidence that a garage pilot needs four ISO certifications before the first customer.

## **10. A regional operator can own the relationship without owning a recycling plant**

The local value can be:

- sourcing;
- collection;
- custody;
- data;
- triage;
- repair;
- resale;
- reporting.

The industrial residue can go downstream.

That is the clearest overall lesson for Dubbo.

## **13. Major unanswered questions worth asking these organisations directly**

### **FlipTech**

1. What did Austin actually accept in the first year from the garage?
2. When did the first business client arrive?
3. What was the first revenue stream?
4. How were true recycling residuals handled before FlipTech had today's facility?
5. At what point did free collection become viable?
6. What percentage of devices are currently reused/refurbished versus material recycled?
7. What certifications does FlipTech currently hold, with certificate/scope numbers?
8. Would FlipTech collect from / partner with a Dubbo regional intake/refurbisher?

### **Renew IT**

1. What did James' 2007 garage model actually look like?
2. How many devices justified moving into dedicated premises?
3. When did buyback become the dominant offer?
4. What device-age/value thresholds determine resale vs recycling?
5. Would Renew IT accept residual e-waste or resale batches from a Dubbo operator?
6. What minimum batch makes regional freight viable?

### **ITC**

1. Minimum regional NSW batch?
2. Can Dubbo equipment be backhauled to North Rocks?
3. What threshold makes collection free?
4. Would ITC accept pre-sanitised residuals?
5. Could a small regional operator act as an intake/triage partner?
6. How is buyback value calculated?
7. What reporting could be white-labelled or passed through?

### **Reconnect**

1. What were the first devices/categories accepted?
2. How did the \$5,000 startup budget break down?
3. What did the home/shared-workspace workflow look like?
4. What percentage of current donations become whole-device reuse?
5. What repair-time/value cutoff is used?
6. What downstream Australian recycler handles the residue?
7. What does a sustainable regional replication model look like?

## WorkVentures

1. Would it accept devices sourced/triaged from regional NSW?
2. What minimum corporate batch is useful?
3. What age/specification/device-lock criteria determine donation suitability?
4. Can a Dubbo community organisation access NSW Device Bank devices?
5. Is there an upstream role for a regional collection/refurb partner?

## LinkBytes

1. Clarify "since 2014" versus Australian company registration in 2023.
2. What is the minimum wholesale lot?
3. What grades/specs do they buy?
4. Are locked/no-drive/parts devices accepted?
5. Would they buy regional NSW refurb batches?
6. What warranty/test grade is required?
7. What certifications apply to ITAD/data services?

## 14. Source register

### FlipTech

- Buy NSW: <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/123199>
- ABR history: <https://abr.business.gov.au/AbnHistory/View?id=54653401024>
- Company LinkedIn: <https://au.linkedin.com/company/fliptech-australia>
- E-waste bins: <https://www.fliptech.com.au/bins>
- Data/security article: <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/8e4e2ca7-22e2-4d68-bf22-d0420c297db4>
- Reuse/refurb mission: <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/53b6be97-e467-4c86-9dc7-7bc1d9dff119>
- Royal Far West partnership: <https://www.fliptech.com.au/articles/3b6db187-5654-4e59-9515-e3202851afce>
- Founder podcast: <https://open.spotify.com/show/4u5ci9897ICp2uuNmi8AOA>
- Founder interview: <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/austin-turpin-applying-bbit-to-build-a-business/id1579827759?i=1000709099232>

### Renew IT

- Main site: <https://renew-it.com/>
- About/team: <https://renew-it.com/about-us/>
- Contact/NSW: <https://renew-it.com/contact-us/>
- Founder/garage/scale: <https://renew-it.com/2024/04/08/national-finalist-in-ey-entrepreneur-of-the-year-2024-australia/>
- News/MICROfactorie/acquisition: <https://renew-it.com/renews/>
- International network: <https://renew-it.com/international/>
- UNSW MICROfactorie: <https://www.smart.unsw.edu.au/news-events/news/commercial-success-story-smarts-plastics-microfactorie-tech>
- ABR group: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?id=21659631946>

## ITC Asset Management

- Main site: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/>
- Buy NSW: <https://buy.nsw.gov.au/supplier/profile/89282>
- ABR: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/56642454395>
- About: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/about-us/>
- ITAD: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/it-asset-disposal-sydney/>
- Data destruction: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/data-destruction-services-sydney/>
- Buyback: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/services/it-asset-buyback-sydney/>
- Regional/national locations: <https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/locations/>

## The Reconnect Project

- Main site: <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/>
- About: <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/about-us/>
- Donate/process: <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/donate/>
- Repair: <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/repair/>
- Training/revenue model: <https://thereconnectproject.com.au/training/>
- NSW Small Business Commissioner story: <https://www.smallbusiness.nsw.gov.au/news-podcasts/news/annette-brodie-how-a-tech-repair-shop-is-making-a-difference-in-sydney>
- Productivity Commission submission: <https://assets.pc.gov.au/387583/sub134-circular-economy.pdf>
- ABR: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/50634550388>
- Early profile: <https://www.frankie.com.au/article/the-reconnect-project-gives-old-technology-a-second-life-563637>

## WorkVentures

- Main/about: <https://workventures.com.au/about-us/>
- History: <https://workventures.com.au/our-history/>
- CircularIT: <https://workventures.com.au/circularit/>
- Refurbishment: <https://workventures.com.au/refurbishment/>
- Store: <https://shop.workventures.com.au/>
- Quality/certification: <https://workventures.com.au/quality-certification/>
- Logistics/certification: <https://workventures.com.au/logistics-solutions/>
- National Device Bank: <https://workventures.com.au/national-device-bank/>
- NSW Device Bank: <https://workventures.com.au/nswdb-eoi/>
- 2024 financial report: <https://workventures.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/WV-2024-Financial-Report-financial.pdf>
- ABR: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View/74002721217>

## LinkBytes

- Main site: <https://www.linkbytes.com.au/>
- ABR: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?id=79673773165>
- LinkedIn: <https://au.linkedin.com/company/link-bytes>
- Wholesale employee/public market evidence: <https://ae.linkedin.com/in/muhammad-faizan-97b4b1169>

## Bottom line

The strongest NSW evidence supports this Dubbo path:

garage/small-workspace startup is plausible; repair/reuse should happen before recycling; business fleet refreshes are a better supply source than random dumping; secure data handling is a sellable service; residual value can subsidise collection; social reuse is viable but needs partner demand; wholesale resale can reduce inventory labour; industrial recycling should stay downstream.

The two companies to study most closely right now are:

- The Reconnect Project for the small, low-capital repair/reuse operating model;
- FlipTech for the garage-to-professional-ITAD growth story.

The company to model the future client workflow on is:

- ITC Asset Management.

The company that best demonstrates the scaled commercial destination is:

- Renew IT.